Chapter 4: From Paragraph to Essay

Writing Technique Questions, "Native American Influence on Modern U.S. Culture" (page 59)

1. The essay contains six paragraphs. There are four paragraphs in the body.
2. Topic sentences:
   Body Paragraph 1: First of all, Native Americans left a permanent imprint on the English language.
   Body Paragraph 2: Art is another area of important Native American contributions.
   Body Paragraph 3: In addition to language and art, agriculture is another area in which Native Americans had a great and lasting influence on the peoples who arrived here from Europe, Africa, and Asia.
   Body Paragraph 4: Finally, it may surprise some people to learn that Americans are also indebted to the native people for our form of government.
3. Native Americans is the key noun. It should be circled five times in body paragraph 1, four times in body paragraph 2, four times in body paragraph 3, once in body paragraph 4, and twice in the concluding paragraph.

Writing Technique Questions (page 61)

1. Funnel: Although not everyone experiences culture shock in exactly the same way, many experts agree that it has roughly five stages.
   Story: The birth of Surtsey, as the island is named, offered scientists an extraordinary opportunity to learn how life takes hold on a sterile landmass.
   Surprising: There are so many conflicting news stories about which foods are good for you that it is often difficult to make the right choices at the supermarket.
   Historical background: Their ability to adjust to life in their adopted land has depended on several factors.
2. Responses will vary.

Practice 1: Introductory Paragraphs (pages 62–63)

Paragraph 1: (5) The way people greet each other when they meet for the first time varies from culture to culture. (2) In some cultures, people bow, and in others, they shake hands. (3) In English-speaking countries, shaking hands is the custom. (6) How one shakes hands sends an important message about one's character. (1) If done properly, a handshake gives the impression of strength and honesty, and if done improperly, it conveys weakness and dishonesty. (4) A proper handshake has four ingredients: pressure, pumps, eye contact, and verbal message.

Type of introduction: funnel.

Paragraph 2: (2) Mr. X went to Mexico from England to manage a milk pasteurization plant. (9) For eight months, he tried every way possible to convince his workers of the importance of punctuality and of checking every detail of their work. (10) The response was always, "Yes, yes, we will do our best," but nothing ever changed. (3) Then one day an impressive

new pasteurization unit arrived and was installed. (1) To celebrate the occasion, Mr. X decided to throw a big party at the plant. (4) The employees did most of the planning and draped the new unit with garlands. (8) The party was a great success, and everybody had a good time. (5) During the party one of Mr. X's supervisors took him aside and said, "Now we see that you are buena gente; from now on I am sure everyone will really try to do their best for you." (6) And so it was—neither punctuality nor quality checks were any longer needed. (7) This story illustrates the need to understand that doing business in a different culture demands an understanding of the culture.

Type of introduction: interesting story.

Paragraph 3: Note: The order of sentences 2, 3, and 4 may vary. (2) In 1976, an earthquake in Tangshan, China, killed over 250,000 people. (4) Iran suffered more than 80,000 deaths in two massive quakes in 1990 and 2003. (3) In an average year, earthquakes kill 10,000 people worldwide and cause millions of dollars worth of property damage. (5) Scientists keep trying to find ways to predict earthquakes—so far without much success. (1) Currently under study are four main methods for predicting when and where the next Big One will occur.

Type of introduction: surprising statistics or facts.

Practice 2: Thesis Statements (page 64)

A. 1. Chronological order
   2. Comparison and contrast

B. 1. Two paragraphs: increased educational opportunities and changes in the country's laws
   2. Four paragraphs: economic independence, political rights, educational opportunities, and social status

Practice 3: Thesis Statements for Logical Division of Ideas (pages 66–67)

A. Check sentences 3, 4, 5, 7, and 10.

B. 2. [Women generally live longer than men] for two main reasons(:) they tend to take better care of their health, and they have better resistance to stress.
   3. [Teenagers declare their separateness from their parents] by the way they dress (and) by the way they talk.
   4. In [choosing a major, a student has to consider various factors], (such as) personal interest, job opportunities, and the availability of training institutions.
   5. [An architect should be] (both) an artist (and) an engineer.
   6. [A healthy lifestyle involves] eating a nutritious diet, exercising regularly, (and) getting enough sleep at night.

C. Answers will vary. Sample answers:
   1. communicating with home/professors/classmates, writing papers, doing research/group assignments, taking online courses

2. their inability to see from far away/listen and write at the same time/know what is important to write down/understand professors who don't speak clearly, their lack of listening skills/English skills/attention
3. good speaking ability, personal charm, leadership ability
4. my parents' inability to understand my generation and not live in the past, differences in how my parents were brought up/in my parents' culture, issues that my generation has that didn't exist in my parents' generation, a rapidly changing world
5. knowing what to do, having a plan, having emergency supplies on hand, following recommended procedures, calm attitude
6. personality, appearance, intelligence, aptitudes
7. cultural attractions, shopping, restaurants, entertainment, public transportation
8. language, food, music, literature, art, clothing, house design and decor

Practice 4: Writing Logical Division Thesis Statements (page 68)

Responses will vary. Sample answers:

1. Three clothing styles you can see at my school include hip-hop, prep, and goth.
2. There are three types of drivers that make our streets unsafe: speeders, cell-phone users, and teenagers.
3. Disneyland and Disney World appeal to both children and adults.
4. Living in a small town has several advantages: little traffic, a low crime rate, friendly neighbors, and community spirit.
5. Advertisers design TV car commercials to appeal to shoppers' different personalities and desires.

Practice 5: Transitions between Paragraphs (pages 70–71)

A. Body paragraph 1: First of all
Body paragraph 2: Although
Body paragraph 3: In addition to, another
Body paragraph 4: Finally
Conclusion: In conclusion

B. Responses will vary. Sample answers:
"Icebergs: A Potential Source of Water"
Paragraph 3: Another serious problem . . .
Paragraph 4: In addition to the problems of towing and melting, . . .
Paragraph 5: If these major problems can be solved, . . .

C. "Medicine and Ethics"
Paragraph 2: The first issue . . .
Paragraph 3: In addition to issues resulting from reproduction technology . . .
Paragraph 4: Moreover, . . .
Paragraph 5: In the latest scientific achievement, . . .
Paragraph 6: To sum up, . . .

Practice 6: Concluding Paragraphs (pages 73–74)

1. Paragraph A gives a summary of the subtopics. Paragraph B paraphrases the thesis statement.
2. Paragraph B gives suggestions. Paragraph A makes a prediction.

Practice 7: Writing Concluding Paragraphs (pages 74–75)

Responses will vary. Sample answers:

Essay 1: To summarize, stress is a health issue for those of us who live in modern, industrialized societies. Unless we want to move to a quiet village in the middle of nowhere, we need to follow the advice of health professionals by setting realistic goals, taking up a hobby, getting regular exercise, and above all, staying close to our families and friends.

Essay 2: In conclusion, studying in the United Kingdom can be a wonderful experience. The British people may be more or less friendly than people at home, the weather may be rainier than the weather you are used to, and you may encounter some frosty stares the first time you forget to queue at the bus stop. Also, it may take you a few days to remember which direction traffic is coming from. However, with time and by maintaining a positive attitude, you will soon adapt to the ways of the British and soon feel comfortable in your temporary home.

Practice 8: Essay Outlining (pages 76–77)

Responses will vary. Suggested completions:

Native American Influences on Modern U.S. Culture

I. Introduction
   Thesis statement: Native Americans have made many valuable contributions to American culture, particularly in the areas of language, art, food, and government.
II. Body
   A. Native Americans left a permanent mark on the English language.
      1. Names of places—cities, towns, rivers, and states
         a. States: Delaware, Iowa, Illinois, Alabama
         b. Cities: Chicago, Miami, Spokane
      2. Names of animals and plants
         a. Animals: chipmunk, moose, raccoon, skunk
         b. Plants: tobacco, squash
   B. Art is another area of important Native American contributions.
      1. Navajo rugs
      2. Silver and turquoise jewelry

3. Handicrafts
   a. Pottery
   b. Leather products
   c. Beadwork

C. Agriculture is another area in which Native Americans had a great and lasting influence on the peoples who arrived here from Europe, Africa, and Asia.
   1. Farming techniques
      a. Fertilization of plants with dead fish
      b. Irrigation methods and crop rotation techniques
   2. New foods
      a. Corn
      b. Chocolate

D. Finally, it may surprise some people to learn that citizens of the United States are also indebted to the native people for our form of government.
   1. Iroquois—large tribe with many branches ("nations")
      Needed to settle disputes among various branches
   2. Five nations formed League of Iroquois
      a. Was autonomous in running its own internal affairs
      b. Acted together when dealing with outsiders
   3. After independence, thirteen colonies needed similar system
      a. Each colony (future state) autonomous in managing own affairs
      b. Would join forces with the other states to deal with matters that concerned them all

III. Conclusion

We can easily see from these few examples the extent of Native American influence on our language, our art forms, our eating habits, and our government.

Reading: "At the Movies—You Are Where You Sit: Seating Choice Can Tell a Lot about a Person."

Questions (page 80)

1. b
2. c
3. "divided moviegoers into four different personality types"
4. quotations and names of characters in movies
5. a. movie characters
   b. quotations
6. We don't know whether the psychologist is correct. The article reports only results, not methods.